
BINANCE

BINANCE LAUNCHES

040 / 14 JUL 2017 / CHANGPENG ZHAO / UNCOMMON

OPEN FOR THE WORLD.

On 14 July 2017, Changpeng Zhao and a team that included colleagues from his earlier company, Bijie Tech, launched Binance. They brought experience building exchange software to a new task: operating a cryptocurrency exchange of their own.

The launch followed the BNB token sale. Binance's announcement of 8 July recorded the issuance of 100 million BNB for the ICO. BNB and the exchange were closely linked from the beginning, but the token sale and the opening of trading were separate events.

This was a small startup, not the vast institution the name would later suggest. Binance's own retrospective describes a founding team of approximately 30 people, mostly former software engineers, initially providing crypto-to-crypto spot trading.

The illustration brings that beginning back to human scale. A dog-like host holds open a glass office door, welcoming the viewer towards colleagues at their desks. Warm light, plants and boxes suggest a young workplace. The character is a symbolic avatar inspired by CZ's Belgian Malinois, Broccoli, not a portrait or a claim that the pet attended the 2017 launch.

Binance's first months also brought disruption. In his later account, Zhao describes the September 2017 restrictions in China and the team's departure. This card stays with the opening chapter, before that relocation and the exchange's later global growth.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 THE WELCOMING HAND

The open palm and hand on the door make the launch an invitation. The pose is fictional staging, not a documented gesture by Zhao.

02 THE GLASS SIGN

BINANCE reads in reverse from the back of the glass. The mirrored letters place the viewer inside the doorway; they do not change the exchange name.

03 THE WORKING TEAM

People remain at desks among boxes and plants. They evoke a small exchange startup, without identifying real employees or reconstructing a particular office.

04 THE SYMBOLIC HOST

The Belgian Malinois character links this card to the later departure in card 090. Broccoli became publicly known in 2025; this is a retrospective visual motif, not a depiction of the pet at the 2017 launch.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Sources: CZ’s 2022 account; BNB issuance announcement, 8 July 2017; Binance’s 2023 founding-team retrospective; CZ's Broccoli post, reported by The Block. The office and character are fictional. Broccoli was publicly introduced in February 2025, after this event. The avatar is not a claim of historical attendance or endorsement of a token. OPEN FOR THE WORLD. is editorial wording, not a quotation. Binance marks belong to their owner; commercial rights and physical-print review remain separate.